

Programming for Economist

PS 2

Class 3

Matias B.F. Hall,
Institute of Economics,
September 2026

KØBENHAVNS UNIVERSITET



Plan for today

1. Working with problem sets
2. Hints for PS2

1. Working with problem sets

- Problem sets will become difficult and have many solutions
- Use code from lectures, previous exercises, friends, LLM's and stack overflow etc.
 - Use what you can, modify and discard the rest
 - Important you understand why the code works as intended
- If you get stuck
 1. Read the documentation
 2. Play around with the code (print)
 3. Look at solution
 4. Ask me/an LLM
- Highly recommended to work in groups, but write your own code

1. New code/errors

When encountering new code:

1. Predict: What do you expect the cell to produce?
2. Run: Execute the cell.
3. Explain: Describe each line and the result in your own words.
 - a. If some of the results don't make sense/are different from you prediction, figure out why. Print each operation, to find where your prediction was wrong.
4. EXTRA to check understanding:
 4. Change: Change one number or one line and run it again.
 5. Rebuild: Later, try to write the small example without looking.

When encountering an error:

1. Read the Error Message, and look at the line of code that gives the error.
2. Check spelling, parentheses and quotation marks.
3. Check whether the required earlier cells were run.

Restarting the kernel and running all cells is a good way to check your work/spot problems with your code.

3. Hints for PS2

- Good hints are already in the problem set itself!
- Q2
 - Create a dictionary `DictName = dict(KeyName = ListName,...)`
 - Alternative: `DictName = {"KeyName": ListName,...}`
 - Access values by: `DictName["KeyName"]`
- Q3

If, elif and else follow this structure:

```
if boolean:
    ...
elif boolean:
    ...
...
else:
    ...
```